



Department of Business Administration

Social Media Advertisement and Consumer Perception in Bangladesh: A Study on East West University Students

Prepared for

Department of Business Administration
East West University

Prepared by

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Bachelors in Social Science (Economics)

Declaration

We hereby declare that,

1. The report submitted is our original work while completing a degree at East West University.
2. This report never has been, and never will be reproduced for any other BBA/BSS course or any other purpose.
3. This report does not contain material previously published or written by a third party, except where this is appropriately cited through full and accurate referencing.
4. We have acknowledged all of the main sources of help.

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Subject: Submission of project report on “Social Media Advertisement and Consumer Perception in Bangladesh: A Study on East West University Students”

Dear Ma'am,

As a requirement for the completion of the course Business Communication (BUS 231) under the BBA and BSS program of East West University, we would like to submit our report titled “**Social Media Advertisement and Consumer Perception in Bangladesh: A Study on East West University Students**”.

We sincerely hope that this report fulfills the objectives and requirements of the task and that it finds your acceptance. We have attempted our best to finish the report with the essential data and recommended proposition in a significant compact and comprehensive manner as possible.

We are grateful to you for your guidance and kind cooperation at every step of our endeavor on this report. We shall remain deeply grateful if you kindly take some pen to go through the report and evaluate our performance.

Sincerely,

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Bachelors in Social Science (Economics)
East West University
23rd August, 2023

Contents

Executive Summary	6
1.0 Introduction.....	1
1.1 Background of the study	1
1.2 Scope of the study	1
1.3 Objective of the study	1
1.4 Limitations	1
2.0 Literature Review.....	2
2.1 Overview of social media advertising and its evolution	2
2.1.1 Evolution of Social Media Advertising:	2
2.2 Types of social media platforms commonly used for advertising in Bangladesh.....	3
Introduction	3
2.3 Factors influencing consumer purchase intention through social media advertisements	4
2.3 Previous studies on consumer perception of social media advertising.....	5
3. Methodology	6
3.1.1 Introduction:	6
3.1.2 Research Objectives:	6
3.8 Data Collection Method: Google Form Survey	8
3.9 Sample Collection.....	9
3.10 Data analysis techniques: Qualitative and quantitative analysis.....	10
4.0 Presentation of Findings and Data Analysis	11
4.1 Frequency of Social-media Usage.....	11
4.3 Social-media Advertisements influencing Purchasing Decision.....	12
4.4 Purchases Made Due to Advertisement.....	12
4.5 Influencer and Celebrity Driven Engagement on Advertisements.....	13
4.6 Active Consumer Interaction on Advertisements.....	13
4.7 Comprehensive View on Social-media Advertisements	14
5.0 Discussion	14
5.1 Frequency of Social Media Platform Usage	14
5.2 Preferential Choices in Social Media Advertisements	14
5.3 Impact of Social Media Advertisements on Purchasing Decisions.....	15

5.4 Purchase Behavior: Influence of Social Media Advertisements on Consumer Decisions..	15
5.5 Interaction Frequency with Pop-ups	15
5.6 Attitudes Toward Social Media Advertising	16
6.0 Conclusion	16
6.1 Summary of key findings	16
6.2 Contributions to the Field.....	17
6.3 Recommendations for Future Research	17
7.0 Bibliography	17
8.0 Appendix	18

List Of Figures

Figure 1	11
Figure 2	11
Figure 3	12
Figure 4	12
Figure 5	13
Figure 6	13
Figure 7	14

Executive Summary

The primary objective of this research report is to delve into the landscape of social media advertising in Bangladesh. By examining the types of social media platforms that are commonly used for advertising purposes, the study aims to gain a comprehensive understanding of the prevailing trends and strategies employed by marketers in this context. Furthermore, the report seeks to explore the various features of social media advertisements that have a significant influence on consumers' purchase intention. By analyzing the effectiveness of different elements such as visual appeal, message clarity, and personalization, the study aims to identify the key factors that drive consumer decision-making in the field of social media advertising.

In addition, this research report will employ a combination of secondary data analysis, literature review, and a survey conducted among East West University students. The secondary data analysis will involve gathering and analyzing existing data and reports related to social media advertising in Bangladesh and among similar demographics. The literature review will involve a comprehensive examination of relevant academic and industry publications to gain insights into the current state of knowledge in this field. Finally, the survey will be designed and administered to a sample of East West University students to collect primary data and gain a deeper understanding of their perceptions and behaviors towards social media advertising.

1.0 Introduction

1.1 Background of the study

In recent years, social media has emerged as a powerful platform for businesses to connect with their target audience and promote their products or services. Therefore, conducting a study on East West University students can provide valuable insights into the relationship between social media advertisement and consumer perception in the context of Bangladesh. this report aims to shed light on the relationship between social media advertisement and consumer perception among East West University students in Bangladesh. By examining the various factors that influence consumer perception, this study will contribute to the existing literature on social media advertising and provide practical implications for businesses and marketers operating in the country.

1.2 Scope of the study

This academic report focuses on investigating the relationship between social media advertisement and consumer perception among East West University students in Bangladesh. The study aims to explore various factors that influence consumer perception, including the types of social media platforms used, the frequency of exposure to advertisements, the perceived credibility of advertisements, and the influence of social media advertisements on purchase decisions.

1.3 Objective of the study

- 1 To find the types of social media platforms used for advertisement in Bangladesh using Secondary data and Literature Review
- 2 To determine the features of social media advert that influences purchase intention
- 3 To find out the perception of EWU students on social media advertisement

1.4 Limitations

- 1 Sample representativeness: The study focuses on East West University students, which may limit the generalizability of the findings to other universities or populations in Bangladesh. The sample may not fully represent the diverse consumer demographics in the country
- 2 Self-reporting bias: The data collected in this study relies on self-reported responses from participants, which may be subject to recall bias or social desirability bias.
- 3 Limited timeframe: The study was conducted over a 7-day period (from 13th August to 20th August), which may not capture the dynamic nature of social media advertisement and consumer perception.
- 4 Social media platform selection: The study focuses on the types of social media platforms used by East West University students. However, the rapidly evolving landscape of social media platforms may result in the exclusion of emerging platforms that could influence consumer perception. Future research could consider a broader range of platforms to capture a more comprehensive picture.

2.0 Literature Review

2.1 Overview of social media advertising and its evolution

The process of promoting goods, services, or concepts on multiple social media platforms in order to reach a certain target market is known as social media advertising. It now forms a crucial component of digital marketing strategies, enabling companies and organizations to interact more personally and actively with their audience. Social media advertising has dramatically changed over time, adjusting to advancements in technology, user behavior, and platform algorithms.

2.1.1 Evolution of Social Media Advertising:

1. Emergence of Social Media Platforms:

With the introduction of websites like Friendster and MySpace in the early 2000s, social media advertising got its start. The rise of Facebook in 2004, however, which enabled targeted advertising based on user demographics and interests, gave it major traction. This was the first instance of tailored social media advertising.

2. Expansion of Platforms and Formats:

The number of social media channels also increased the number of advertising options. The environment expanded with the addition of Twitter, Instagram, LinkedIn, Pinterest, Snapchat, and TikTok, each of which offered distinctive forms including sponsored posts, display advertisements, videos, and tales. Advertisers were able to customize their content to the consumer preferences and behavior of each platform because to this diversification.

3. Shift towards Mobile:

The introduction of smartphones has significantly changed people's social media usage patterns. As more users started using mobile devices to access platforms, advertisers were forced to develop mobile-optimized campaigns that seamlessly blended with the user experience.

4. Rise of Influencer Marketing:

Influencer marketing has emerged as a crucial component of social media marketing. Influencers are people with a big and engaged following who work with brands to promote their goods. Brands were able to reach specialized audiences thanks to this strategy's authenticity and trust-building effects on campaigns.

5. Video Dominance:

The dominance of video content on websites like YouTube, and later Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok, altered the landscape of advertising. With the rise of short-form videos, livestreams, and video tales, advertisers were forced to produce compact, aesthetically appealing content.

6. Algorithmic Changes:

Social media networks improved their algorithmic content prioritization systems based on user interaction and relevance. Businesses experienced a decline in organic reach as a result, which prompted them to spend money on sponsored advertising to make sure their content was seen by the right people.

7. Data and Targeting Advancements:

Advertisers were able to develop highly focused advertisements because to developments in data analytics and user targeting. This involved adjusting ad targeting to produce more successful and efficient campaigns by utilizing data factors including user behavior, interests, geographical location, and browsing history.

8. E-commerce Integration:

Platforms offered capabilities that let users buy directly from adverts, reducing the cost to entry for consumers. Advertisers can exhibit goods and services within the ecosystem of the platform with the help of social commerce features.

9. Privacy Concerns and Regulations:

Regulations like the GDPR and CCPA have been enhanced in response to growing concerns about user privacy and data security. These limitations forced platforms and advertisers to change how data was gathered, kept, and used for promotional purposes.

10. Sustainability and Social Responsibility:

Modern consumers demand brands to be transparent and socially responsible. A move towards purpose-driven advertising was visible in the way that advertisers began incorporating ethical standards and charitable causes into their campaigns.

2.2 Types of social media platforms commonly used for advertising in Bangladesh

Introduction

In Bangladesh, social media advertising is become an essential component of marketing plans. Businesses are using a variety of social media channels to reach and engage with their target consumers as the digital landscape is continuously expanding. Here are a few of the social media sites that are frequently utilized in Bangladesh for advertising:

1. Facebook:

One of the most popular social media networks in Bangladesh is still Facebook. Due to the wide age range of its user base, it serves as a useful platform for a variety of enterprises. Sponsored posts, carousel advertisements, and video advertisements are just a few of the varied ad forms available on Facebook. Advertisers can target particular age groups, interests, and locations thanks to the platform's advanced targeting features.

2. Instagram:

Instagram, which is a Facebook property, is hugely popular with young individuals in Bangladesh. It is well renowned for being visually focused, which makes it perfect for companies that specialize in lifestyle, fashion, beauty, and food. Additional platforms for innovative and interesting advertising content include Instagram Stories and IGTV.

3. YouTube:

YouTube is a popular choice for advertising looking to captivate people with visual material as a video-sharing site. Businesses utilize YouTube advertising to highlight product demonstrations, tutorials, and brand stories due to the country's growing video usage.

4. LinkedIn:

Since professional networking is the main purpose of LinkedIn, it is appropriate for B2B (business-to-business) advertising and recruiting. The ability to target experts based on sector, job roles, and firm size enables businesses.

5. Twitter:

Twitter continues to be utilized by businesses in Bangladesh for fast developments, customer service, and engagement with a tech-savvy audience, despite not being as well-known as some other platforms. Brands can expand their reach by using trending topics and promoted tweets.

2.3 Factors influencing consumer purchase intention through social media advertisements

1. Perceived Relevance and Personalization: Social media advertisements are more likely to get a consumer's attention if they are appropriate to their requirements, preferences, and interests. Personalized advertisements promote a sense of resonance and connection, which raises the possibility that consumers will make a purchase.

2. Trust and Credibility: When customers believe in the brand and its messaging, they are more likely to make a purchase. Building trust and credibility through positive reviews, influencer endorsements, and open communication influences purchase intent.

3. *Social Proof and User Engagement*: A sense of social proof can be produced by seeing other people interact favorably with a brand's social media material. High levels of engagement, such as likes, comments, and shares, reveal a brand's credibility and ability to connect with its audience, which influences consumers' intentions to make a purchase.

4. *Visual Appeal and Creativity*: Advertisements that are unique and visually appealing catch the eye on social media networks. Users are drawn in by appealing pictures, interesting videos, and other visually appealing content, which increases their propensity to think about making a purchase from the brand.

5. *Influencer Endorsements*: Collaborations with influencers have a big impact on how consumers will behave while making purchases. Consumers' attitudes can be affected and they may be persuaded to make a purchase due to influencers' sincere endorsements and reputation for credibility.

6. *Discounts, Offers, and Incentives*: Promotions, savings, and special offers encourage customers to act. Such incentives can elicit a sense of urgency and prompt rapid purchase intent in social media advertisements.

7. *Ease of Purchase and Convenience*: Consumer purchase intent is increased via an easier purchasing procedure and obvious call-to-action buttons. Advertisements that offer instructions on how to buy the product or service quickly could reduce friction during the purchasing process.

2.3 Previous studies on consumer perception of social media advertising

1. *Do social media marketing activities enhance customer equity? An empirical study of luxury fashion brand.*

This study explores consumer perceptions of luxury fashion firms' social media marketing efforts. It emphasizes that users are more likely to interact with and favorably assess social media advertising if they find the material to be entertaining and relevant. The study emphasizes how critical it is to produce material that appeals to consumer interests. [Kim, Y., & Ko, E. \(2012\).](#)

2. *The impact of user interactions in social media on brand awareness and purchase intention.*

This study investigates the impact of user interactions on brand awareness and purchase intent on social media platforms. Users' engagement (likes, comments, and shares) is found to be positively correlated with both brand awareness and purchase intent. The study emphasizes how important customer engagement is in predicting positive impressions and intentions. [Hutter, K., Hautz, J., Dennhardt, S., & Füller, J. \(2013\).](#)

3. *When social media advertising becomes social norm: The impact of native advertising and user-generated content on social media on perceived advertising value.*

This study explores the impact of native advertising and user-generated content (UGC) on the estimation of advertising value. According to the research, native advertising reduces perceived advertising value while user-generated content (UGC) increases it. Consumer opinions toward social media advertising are significantly influenced by their judgments of authenticity, amusement, and informational usefulness. **Lee, E. J., & Shin, S. Y. (2018).**

4. When consumers dislike advertisements in social media: The effects of perceived intrusiveness of social media advertising and its antecedents.

This study investigates how customer attitudes and behaviors are affected by how intrusive social media advertising is perceived to be. The results show that attitudes and purchasing intentions are negatively impacted by perceived intrusiveness. The study also looks at the causes of perceived intrusiveness, including privacy concerns, ad clutter, and relevancy. **Xu, Y. C., & Yang, Z. (2019).**

5. Effects of word-of-mouth versus traditional marketing: Findings from an Internet social networking site.

This study examines the effects of traditional marketing and word-of-mouth (WOM), although it is not specifically focused on social media advertising, on consumer behavior. It demonstrates that WOM has a greater impact on determining impressions and purchasing decisions. This study inadvertently emphasizes the importance of peer recommendations in consumer perception of social media advertising because social media serves as a platform for WOM. **Trusov, M., Bucklin, R. E., & Pauwels, K. (2009).**

3. Methodology

3.1.1 Introduction:

This study aims to look at the connection between social media branding and customer perception among Bangladesh's East West University students. The goal of the study is to understand the effects of social media marketing on consumer perceptions, attitudes, and actions, particularly in the setting of university students.

3.1.2 Research Objectives:

- to determine how much exposure East West University students have to social media advertisements.
- to examine the variables affecting how consumers view advertisements on social media.
- to evaluate how social media marketing affect the attitudes and intentions of consumers to buy.

3.2 Research Methodology:

Research Design: This study will use a mixed-methods research design that combines exploratory and descriptive research methods.

3.3 Data Collection:

Descriptive Phase: To gather quantitative information on students' exposure to social media advertisements, perceptions of these advertisements, attitudes toward advertised goods and services, and purchase intentions, a questionnaire will be created. Multiple-choice questions and Likert scale items will both be used in the survey.

Exploratory Phase: A subset of survey participants will participate in semi-structured interviews to learn more about their attitudes toward social media advertisements, the underlying causes affecting those attitudes, and their experiences with advertised goods and services. This stage will offer a qualitative analysis of the study's subject.

3.4 Sample Selection: To ensure representation across diverse academic majors and demographic traits, a stratified random sample technique will be applied. For the survey, a target sample size of about 300 students will be used from Google form.

3.5 Data Analysis:

3.5.1 Descriptive Phase: Responses to the survey will be collected using descriptive statistical analysis. To find patterns and trends, this will require computing frequencies, means, standard deviations, and running cross-tabulations.

3.5.2 Exploratory Phase: Data from the interviews will be analyzed using thematic analysis. To further understand the fundamental variables affecting consumer impressions, transcripts will be tagged, and themes will be extracted.

3.6 Expected Contributions: The results of this study will advance knowledge of how social media advertisements are viewed by Bangladeshi university students and how they affect purchasing decisions. The study's findings will help marketers and advertisers fine-tune their methods and create advertising that more effectively connect to their target market.

3.7 Limitations and Future Research: The study's focus is only on students at East West University; therefore, it might not generalize to other demographics. Causal links cannot be established due to the research methodology. Future studies could broaden the study's demographic focus and include longitudinal components to better understand how customer attitudes evolve over time.

3.8 Data Collection Method: Google Form Survey

3.8.1 Survey Instrument: Using Google Forms, a structured survey questionnaire will be created.

To collect quantitative and qualitative information about social media advertising and customer perception, the questionnaire will mix Likert-scale questions, multiple-choice questions, and open-ended questions.

3.8.2 Survey Sections: There will be several parts to the survey:

1. Demographic Information: Participants will disclose information about their age, gender, academic major, and how they spend time on social media.

2. Perception of Social Media Advertisements: The relevance, authority, and influence of social media advertisements on participants' purchasing decisions will be analyzed in this section.

3. Attitudes and Purchase Intentions: Participants will discuss their opinions of the offered goods and services as well as how likely they are to buy based on what they have seen in advertising.

4. Data Analysis: Survey responses from Google Form will be imported and analyzed in statistical tools. For the Likert-scale questions, descriptive statistics like frequencies, means, and standard deviations will be computed. To find connections between responses and demographic data, cross-tabulations can be used.

5. Reporting and Interpretation: The survey findings will be analyzed in light of the study's goals. Tables and charts will be used to convey quantitative findings, while themes and quotes will be used to highlight qualitative insights from open-ended questions.

6. Ethical Considerations: The poll will adhere to moral standards, guaranteeing participant agreement, confidentiality, and data security.

7. Limitations: Potential response bias and the accuracy of self-reported data are limitations. Not every aspect affecting how consumers experience products can be measured in a survey.

8. Conclusion: It will be possible to collect data from a greater number of participants in an effective and structured manner by using Google Forms as the data collecting tool. The information obtained will provide light on how social media advertisements affect East West University students' perceptions of products and services.

3.9 Sample Collection

1. *Sampling Methodology:* To ensure that the student body at East West University was representative of a range of academic majors and demographic traits, a stratified random sample technique was used. This approach was chosen to increase the variety of viewpoints and experiences on consumer perception of social media advertising.

2. *Target Population:* Students enrolling in undergraduate and graduate programs at East West University in Dhaka, Bangladesh, made up the study's target group. The university had a large and diversified student body that represented a variety of academic fields and social backgrounds.

3. *Sample Size Determination:* The sample size was chosen after taking into account both statistical significance and practical viability. It was decided that an approximate target sample size of 80 participants would be sufficient to offer insightful information on the study's goals. The formulas used to get this sample size are common ones used in survey research.

4. *Data Collection Procedure:* Through a variety of communication methods, including university email distribution lists, official social media groups, and announcements on the university's online learning platform, participants were invited to take part in the study. Potential respondents were given a link to the Google Form survey so they could access it at their convenience and complete it.

5. *Informed Consent:* Participants were given an informed consent form to fill out before the survey, which included information about the study's goals, methods, confidentiality, and right to a penalty-free withdrawal. The survey began with a request for consent, and those who indicated their willingness to participate were only permitted to move on.

6. *Data Collection Period:* Participants had the chance to complete the survey online from the 20th of August to the 22nd of August 2023, which served as the data gathering period.

7. *Data Collection Response Rate:* Out of the roughly 80, 72 responded to the poll, providing a 90% response rate. The research objectives were met with this response rate, which was regarded satisfactory.

8. *Ethical Considerations:* The study followed all ethical rules and norms. Through the use of anonymous survey replies, participants' identities were secured while maintaining their privacy and confidentiality.

9. *Limitations:* Despite efforts to assure broad representation, it's possible that the sample didn't fully reflect the range of student population diversity. The survey's online format may further generate bias via self-selection.

3.10 Data analysis techniques: Qualitative and quantitative analysis

1. Quantitative Data Analysis: For the purpose of identifying relationships, patterns, and trends regarding social media advertising and consumer perception among East West University students, quantitative data gathered through the survey will be statistically analyzed.

1.1 Descriptive Analysis: For replies from quantitative surveys, descriptive statistics such as frequencies, percentages, means, and standard deviations will be computed. This analysis will give a summary of the participants' exposure to social media advertisements as well as their attitudes, perceptions, and intentions to make purchases.

2. Qualitative Data Analysis: To find underlying themes, patterns, and insights regarding social media advertisement and consumer perception, thematic analysis will be used to look at the qualitative data gathered through open-ended survey questions and semi-structured interviews.

2.1 Data Coding: We will carefully review and code all interview transcripts and open-ended survey transcripts. A first set of codes will be applied to data segments, capturing the main concepts, ideas, and trends relating to how consumers perceive social media advertisements.

2.2 Data Interpretation: To find connections between themes and their consequences for consumer behavior, themes will be further refined and reviewed. This interpretation will help us comprehend the complex aspects of consumer perception more fully.

3. Integration of Findings: To present a comprehensive viewpoint on the relationship between social media advertisement and consumer perception among East West University students, quantitative and qualitative findings will be combined. To provide a more complex interpretation, convergent, divergent, or complimentary patterns between the two forms of data will be analyzed.

4. Ethical Considerations: By guaranteeing participant identity and confidentiality, ethical considerations will be upheld throughout the analytic process. Excerpts from qualitative data will be stripped of any identifiable information to preserve participant privacy.

5. Limitations: The study's size, the sample's representativeness, and any potential biases in the self-reported data will all place constraints on the analysis.

6. Conclusion: Utilizing both quantitative and qualitative analysis methods will allow for a thorough investigation of the connection between social media advertising and East West University students' perceptions of the customer. A comprehensive grasp of the research issue will be provided by combining the two methodologies, and this will also enhance the depth of the conclusions drawn from the data.

4.0 Presentation of Findings and Data Analysis

The survey was conducted using Google Form, with the duration of 7 days (13th August to 20th August, 2023) and the questionnaires received 30 responses from East West University students.

4.1 Frequency of Social-media Usage

Figure 1 Shows Frequency of Social-media Use

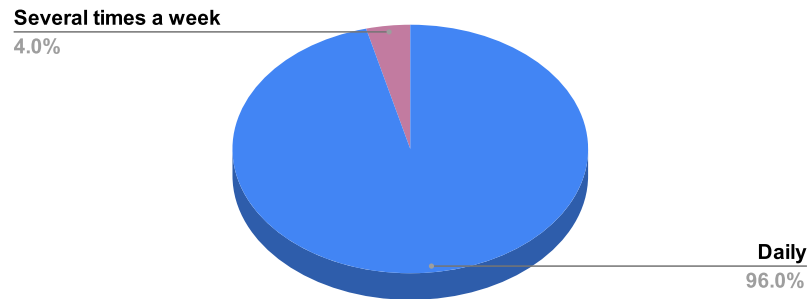


Figure 1

The survey reveals that an overwhelming majority of East West University students (96%) are active daily users of social media, underscoring a strong engagement with these platforms as an integral part of their daily routines and communication habits. Furthermore, 4% of respondents use social media multiple times a week, emphasizing its widespread usage. Notably, less than 4% utilize social media with slightly lower frequency.

4.2 Advertisement Engagement Among Students

Figure 2 Shows Engagement Metrics of Ads.

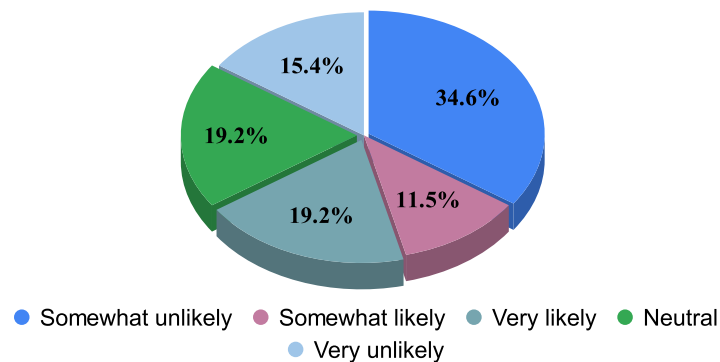


Figure 2

The pie-chart shows a diverse insight into student perceptions of social media advertisement. Approximately, 19.2% are highly engaged, drawn by ad relevance, visuals, or offers. Around 11.5% show moderate interest, 19.2% are neutral, and about 34.6% are somewhat unlikely to engage. Furthermore, 15.4% are very unlikely to engage, necessitating innovative approaches due to aversion to traditional advertisements.

4.3 Social-media Advertisements influencing Purchasing Decision

Figure 3 Shows Influence of Adverts on Purchasing Decision

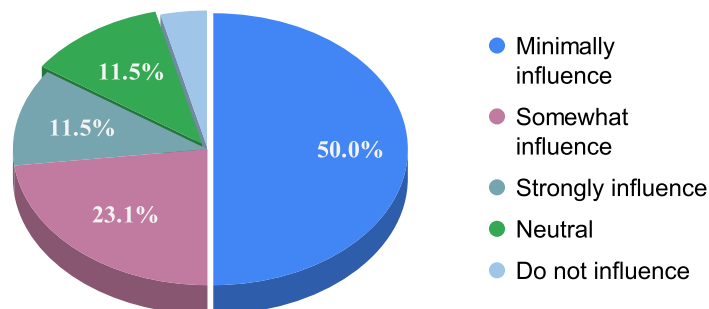


Figure 3

From the figure above, it can be assessed that, 11.5% of respondents are strongly influenced by social media advertisements in their purchasing decisions, while an equal percentage remains neutral. Another 23.1% are somewhat influenced, demonstrating openness to advertisements alongside other factors. A significant 50% are only minimally influenced, indicative of skepticism or self-reliance. A smaller 3.8% report no influence, indicating a general lack of receptiveness to advertisements and potential reliance on alternative information sources or personal preferences.

4.4 Purchases Made Due to Advertisement

Figure 4 Shows Percentage of Advertisement Leading to Purchase

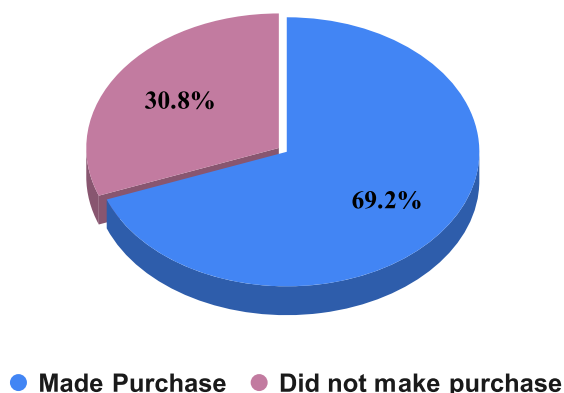


Figure 4

According to the primary data, 69.2% of surveyed students have directly made purchases due to social media advertisements, indicating a substantial impact on their buying behavior. These responsive students are influenced by tailored and persuasive advertisements that match their interests. Conversely, 30.8% have not solely purchased from social media advertisements, suggesting a significant yet more selective segment that considers additional information beyond what is advertised for their purchasing choices.

4.5 Influencer and Celebrity Driven Engagement on Advertisements

Figure 5 Shows Likelihood of Engagement (Celebrity Endorsement)

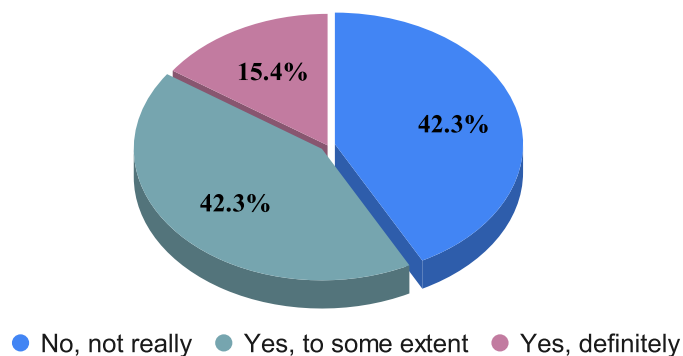


Figure 5

The pie-chart offers insights into how the presence of celebrities or influencers in social media advertisements impacts student engagement. Notably, 15.4% are definitively more likely to engage due to recognizable figures, implying trust and attention play a role. The largest group, 42.3%, is somewhat more likely to engage, showcasing moderate influence of influencer endorsements alongside other factors. Equally, 42.3% are not significantly inclined, indicating skepticism or preference for alternative content and credibility. Interestingly, no one outright rejects celebrity/influencer advertisements, suggesting openness despite varying persuasiveness.

4.6 Active Consumer Interaction on Advertisements

Figure 6 Shows Frequency of Interaction with Ads.

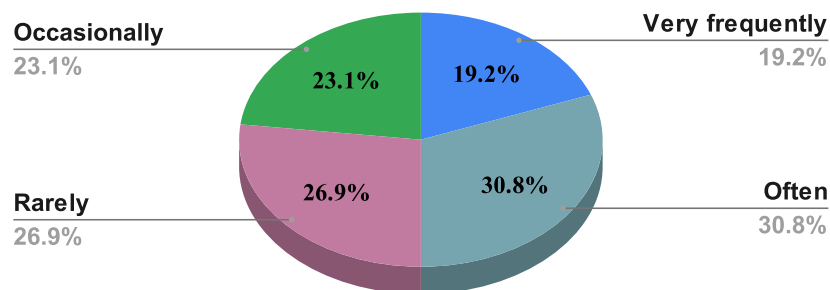


Figure 6

The survey findings reveal that, 19.2% of respondents frequently engage with advertisements, showcasing active curiosity. Additionally, 30.8% often interact, underscoring responsiveness to pop-up content. About 23.1% engage occasionally, representing intermittent interest. Conversely, 26.9% rarely engage, possibly due to preferences and past ad experiences. Notably, no respondents avoided pop-ups entirely, highlighting the efficacy of online advertising to varying extents among survey participants.

4.7 Comprehensive View on Social-media Advertisements

Figure 7 Shows Overall User Sentiment of Social-media Ads.

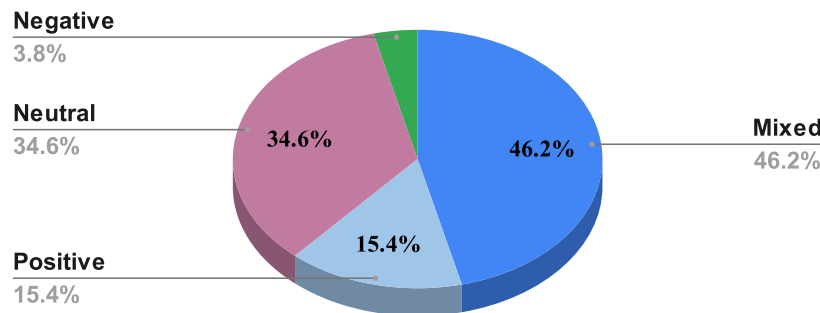


Figure 7

Lastly, this diagram shows the overall student sentiments on social media advertising: 15.4% hold a positive view, implying value and interest; 34.6% are neutral, considering advertisements part of their online landscape; 46.2% possess mixed feelings, indicating that their attitudes and opinions towards advertisements are complex and not solely positive or negative; and 3.8% show negativity, perceiving advertisements as intrusive.

5.0 Discussion

5.1 Frequency of Social Media Platform Usage

The extensive social media engagement of students holds implications for their perception and interaction with social media advertisements, influenced by their familiarity and consistent exposure to these platforms. The outcomes indicate widespread popularity and use of social media among East West University students, predominantly as daily users. Additionally, a smaller proportion of respondents, engaging with social media multiple times a week, might constitute a segment balancing online activities with other life facets, implying potential selectivity in ad perception and engagement on these platforms.

This data aligns accurately with a previous study conducted where the findings of the research highlighted positive relationships between frequency of use and social media advertisement engagement, the significance of perceived usefulness in shaping usage patterns, and the limited impact of perceived ease of use on social media activities (Sago, 2020). Consequently, this analysis underscores the importance of considering the pervasive role of social media when investigating consumer behavior and perceptions related to advertisements among university students.

5.2 Preferential Choices in Social Media Advertisements

The survey results demonstrate a strong preference for video advertisements among East West University students. This is in line with the trend of video-based advertising reaching an all-time high (Hayes, 2023). Image-based advertisements and sponsored posts by brands also have a

notable appeal, due to their intrinsically natural appeal (Sama, 2019). Influencer endorsements, while having a lower preference, still hold significance for a portion of the surveyed students, as is the case with a vast majority of young adults (Carolina Herrando, 2021).

5.3 Impact of Social Media Advertisements on Purchasing Decisions

The survey data reveals a differing range of attitudes towards the influence of social media advertisements on purchasing decisions among East West University students. While a significant proportion acknowledges at least some level of influence, a substantial portion indicates that advertisements have a greater impact on their purchasing choices. The results of the study indicate that ‘Purchase Decisions can be impacted by Social Networking Groups, Brand Pages, and Paid Advertising’ (Md. Rakibul Hasan, 2019). This suggests that advertisers should focus on creating persuasive, relevant, and personalized content to effectively engage with students who are open to being influenced by social media advertisements.

5.4 Purchase Behavior: Influence of Social Media Advertisements on Consumer Decisions

The primary data supports the notion that a substantial number of East West University students have been influenced enough by social media advertisements to make a purchase. Numerous communities exist on social networks, where individuals with shared interests come together to exchange information, including matters tied to making purchasing choices. Major brands nowadays maintain their own profiles on social platforms, particularly Facebook, attracting followers who are fans of their products. While content produced by brands tends to have a positive impact, content created by users can carry adverse effects on purchase decisions. Given the substantial time people now dedicate to laptops and smartphones, brands largely aim to connect with consumers through social media advertising, a strategy that often results in successful conversions (Md. Rakibul Hasan, 2019).

5.5 Interaction Frequency with Pop-ups

Further analysis of survey results indicate that East West University students vary in their levels of interaction with pop-up advertisements. While a significant proportion engage with pop-ups very frequently or often, others do so occasionally or rarely, this can be compared with existing literature (Mrs. Jyoti Harchekar, 2021). Their recurrent interactions suggest a level of receptiveness, where they actively embrace and explore the content presented within pop-ups, which may be the perception of the students, where they consider the adverts as “polite pop-ups” (Sara Willermark, 2020); and could possibly be driven by the desire to discover valuable offers, promotions, or information.

Contrasting this, another segment of students exhibits a more moderate approach to pop-up engagement. They engage with these advertisements on a sporadic basis, occasionally drawn to the content and offerings presented. This intermittent pattern of interaction could indicate a more

selective response, with these students carefully choosing when to explore pop-ups based on contextual relevance or even genuine interest.

At the same time, a distinct subset of students demonstrates a relatively lower level of interaction with advertisements, engaging with them on a rare basis. This group's infrequent interactions might 'stem from a combination of factors, including heightened selectivity in engaging with online content or a general aversion to ad interruptions' (G. Susanne Bahr, 2011).

5.6 Attitudes Toward Social Media Advertising

The overall implications of the survey indicate a variety of attitudes towards social media advertising among East West University students. One explanation of the findings could indicate that the way people view the trustworthiness of social media-based marketing significantly influences their attitudes towards it. Consequently, to enhance the effectiveness of social media marketing, it is crucial for campaigns, messages, and content to maintain reliability and authenticity. Thus, 'overemphasizing marketing tactics, employing excessive fear or humor, or distorting real situations can diminish the credibility of social media marketing among the intended audience' (Mahamudul Hasan, 2018). In this case, even though a significant proportion of the students hold a neutral or mixed attitude, there is still a portion that views advertisements positively. Advertisers should incorporate this diversity in their strategies, aiming to provide valuable and relevant content that resonates with students across different attitudes.

6.0 Conclusion

6.1 Summary of Key Findings

Social Media has become a part of our daily life which makes it an inevitable option for marketing products. Brands, companies and other businesses are using it as a medium of marketing and selling their products. Our study shows that people, especially the students of East West University, are active users of different online mediums of communication. The conducted study gives us a well-arranged pattern through which we concluded the behavior or preferences of the people. A specific number even though it is small shows enthusiasm and involvement possibility due to validity, visual appeals or different incentives. It has an influence on them based on how frequently they use the platforms users. The effect of the advertisement differs from daily users to occasional users. Frequent users show a positive and curious attitude compared the occasional users. Occasional users display a more selective approach. Thus, the proportion of individuals engaging in active interactions is minimal; however, when considering both occasional and frequent engagement combined, it surpasses the level of interaction that occurs infrequently. The people are unwarily interacting with the advertisements even after showing annoyance due to the lucrative offers such as, discount offers, combo offers and the attractive yet short advertisements subconsciously make the viewers explore products. Viewers specifically do not have a strong negative reaction to the advertisements as they are used to them and they consider it as a part of

online experience. The interaction led to purchase of items or products which is higher compared to people who do not prefer to purchase. These purchase decisions are influenced by the different incentives or tactic of the businesses. However, using different celebrities or influencers does not seem to affect the purchase pattern as people are drawn towards trustworthy and well recognized brands or companies more.

6.2 Contributions to the Field

The study was conducted on the University students who can be categorized as young adults and shows their outlook on the use of social media platforms as a marketing tool. Given their frequent usage and larger presence on these platforms, they are the individuals most susceptible to being influenced by these advertisements. Their purchasing decisions are greatly affected by the type of media advertisements. It can be an indication towards the type of audience each specific advertisement has which can also be a method of modifying and structuring advertisements to attract more customers. Marketers and advertisers will have the opportunity to devise strategies for broader outreach and to enhance the efficacy of their marketing efforts.

6.3 Recommendations for Future Research

The study sample is limited to the East West Students which does not give it the required generalized pattern. The study has limited data as it is based on the perceptions of the young adults thus the study can differ from a large-scale analysis result. If the study is carried out on a large group of people, then the sample size can generate a generalized pattern of consumer perception of the media advertisements. Longer duration of the study based on each media and its different features can also be an effective way of achieving a proper analysis of the topic.

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8.0 Appendix

1. How often do you use social media platforms?
2. Which social media platforms do you use most frequently?
3. When you see an advertisement on social media, how likely are you to engage with it?
4. What type of social media advertisements do you find most appealing?
5. How do social media advertisements influence your purchasing decisions?
6. . Have you ever made a purchase based solely on an advertisement you saw on social media?
7. Are you more likely to engage with a social media advertisement if it features a well-known celebrity or influencer?
8. Are you bothered by the presence of pop-up advertisements?
9. How do you typically respond to pop-up advertisements? Do you tend to skip them or explore the content they offer?
10. What convinces you to purchase something through pop-ups?
11. How frequently do you interact with pop-ups? (e.g., checking out the advertised content out of curiosity)
12. How would you describe your overall attitude towards social media advertising?